

STATE REVIEW LEARNINGS:

SOUTHERN ARKANSAS UNIVERSITY

TRADITIONAL

On-Site Review: April 3-4, 2024

WHAT'S IN THIS REPORT?

The report uses evidence from state data collection and an on-site review to examine educator preparation program performance. The information in this report is meant to inform a continuous improvement process that takes educator preparation programs closer to the goals needed to serve Arkansas's students.

This report rates the EPP on all three Standards of the Arkansas Education Preparation Provider State Review Framework, which are fundamental to support teacher candidates in their journey to becoming successful teachers who meet the needs of students in Arkansas:

- Standard 1, "Candidate Recruitment and Completion," is rated primarily with quantitative data from state data collection.
- For Standard 2, "Preparing Candidates Effectively," criteria to assess performance results from document review, observations, and focus group conversations with stakeholders, including teacher preparation program deans, candidates, current school leaders and teachers, faculty, and the DESE staff.
- The ratings for Standard 3, "Supporting Workforce Needs," are based on state data reporting.

Performance Levels are defined as follows:

Performance Level	Average Score Equivalent
EXCEEDS	Average score equivalent to exceeds on two of three standards or indicators
MEETS	Average score equivalent to meets on all three standards or indicators
APPROACHING	Average score equivalent to approaching on one standard or indicator and meets on the other two
BELOW	Average score equivalent to below on one standard or indicator and approaching on the other two

SOUTHERN ARKANSAS UNIVERSITY

TRADITIONAL

Overall Performance Level		
MEETS		
Performance Levels by Standard		
Standard 1: Recruitment & Completion	Standard 2: Preparing Candidates Effectively	Standard 3: Supporting Workforce Needs
MEETS	MEETS	MEETS

STANDARD 1: RECRUITMENT & COMPLETION

Standard 1 Performance Level		
MEETS		
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 1.1 Plans	Indicator 1.2 Recruitment	Indicator 1.3 Completion
MEETS	APPROACHING	EXCEEDS
Recommendations		
- Begin preparing to submit a formal plan in October that addresses all Indicators in the State Review Framework and provides evidence of action towards continuous improvement. (Focus Area: Criteria 1.1a) - Recruiting additional candidates in subject shortage areas will support the program's Standard 1 performance moving forward. (Focus Area: Criteria 1.2b)		

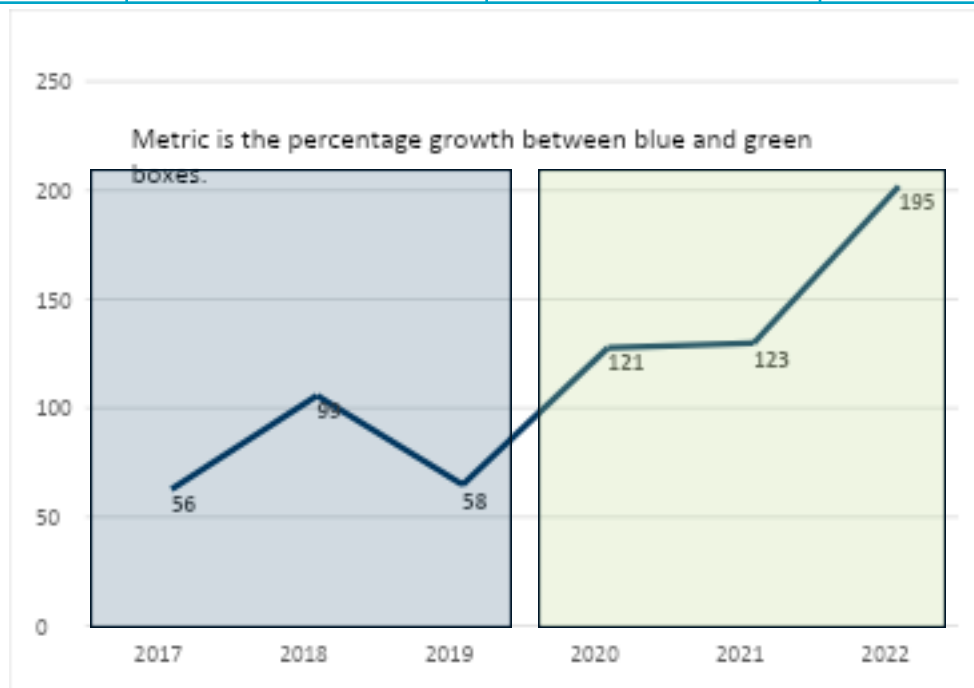
INDICATOR 1.1: PLANS

Criteria 1.1a: Programs have formal plans to meet the targets described in the state review framework (i.e., Standards 1-3) and show evidence of acting on their plans	
Performance Level	Explanation
MEETS	EPPs were not asked to submit formal plans to meet the state review framework targets or to show evidence of acting on their plans as part of the Spring 2024 review cycle. As a result, all EPPs in this cycle will receive a rating of MEETS.

INDICATOR 1.2: RECRUITMENT

Criteria 1.2a: Programs meet annual recruitment targets that align with their program size and Arkansas's workforce needs

Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Growth in 3yr Average Enrollment	Performance Level
Percentage growth in 3yr average enrollment	10%	106.1%	EXCEEDS



*The enrollment growth target was established to close the sizeable gap between EPP completers and those leaving the classroom over the next 10yrs. EPPs can earn a "Meets" rating by demonstrating positive program enrollment growth (i.e., growth greater than zero) and an "Exceeds" rating by demonstrating growth greater than 10 percent.

Criteria 1.2b: Programs recruit candidates for Arkansas certification shortage areas in proportion to the need

Metric	Target	EPP's Percent of new enrollees in Shortage Areas	Performance Level
Percentage of program candidates recruited in shortage areas	24%	12%	BELOW

Shortage Area Enrollment

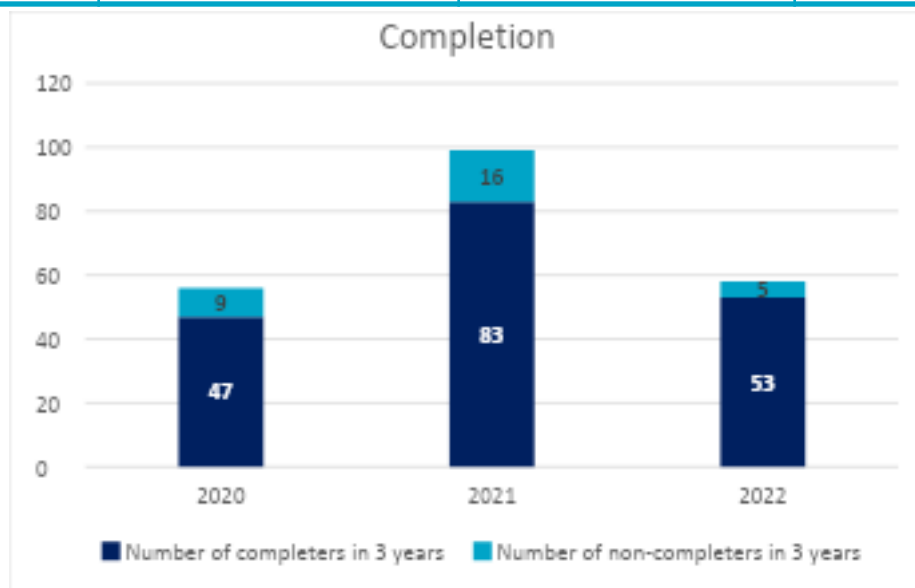
250

*Shortage Areas are based on an analysis of 3yrs of data related to teacher supply (EPP pipeline), demand (unlicensed teachers, attrition, deceased), and state focus areas. Current licensure areas of shortage: Computer Science (4-12), Biology (7-12), Chemistry (7-12), Physics (7-12), Foreign Language (K-12), Math (7-12), Math (4-8), Science (4-8), Special Education (K-12)

INDICATOR 1.3: COMPLETION

Criteria 1.3a: Candidates have high rates of completion

Metric	Target	EPP's 3-Year Completion Rate	Performance Level
Three-year average completion rate	75%	86%	EXCEEDS



Standard 2: PREPARING CANDIDATES EFFECTIVELY

Standard 2 Performance Level		
MEETS		
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 2.1 Coursework	Indicator 2.2 Clinical Experiences	Indicator 2.3 Development
MEETS	EXCEEDS	MEETS
Recommendations		
The traditional program at Southern Arkansas University provided evidence to highlight its commitment to using data to develop its coursework, design its clinical internship, and support teacher candidates. SAU regularly surveys course instructors, clinical supervisors, mentor teachers, and teacher candidates to better understand what is working well and where to continue to improve. Course instructors and clinical supervisors are a strength at SAU, providing candidates with support and feedback. SAU's clinical experiences are particularly strong due to the Rider Residency. Recommendations to strengthen candidate preparation include: • By 2024–25, EPPs will need to show evidence that the Aspiring Teacher Rubric is in use. Training and norming on the rubric should be completed for clinical supervisors to ensure use for the Fall 2024. • By 2026–2027, EPPs will need to provide evidence that experienced mentor teachers working with year-long residents have received DESE-recognized coaching training. • Southern Arkansas University should continue planning to meet the state's one-year residency requirement, which will apply to spring 2027 completers and beyond.		

INDICATOR 2.1: COURSEWORK

Criteria 2.1a: Candidates receive high-quality program coursework that is evidence-based
MEETS
Metric 1: Incorporation and demonstration of best practices around content instruction MEETS Coursework clearly and intentionally incorporates nationally recognized best practices around content instruction, including recognizing and using high-quality instructional materials and evidence-based practices. For example, in EED 4173 Teaching Literacy I, participants become familiar with CKLA and 95 Percent Phonics. Assessment Driven Math Instruction (MAED 4373) references Illustrative Math and Math Quest. Social Studies for Teachers (TEDU 4363) includes the C3 Framework and the Inquiry Design Model. Science of Reading (SOR) courses align with DESE-approved requirements: Reading Diagnostics (EDUC 4113), Strategies for Content Area Reading (EDUC 4203), and AR IDEAS (18 hours). In course observations, reviewers saw best practices in teaching, including modeling, turn and talk strategies, close reading activities, and working with a Pearson HQIM, "My Perspectives." Metric 2: Incorporation and utilization of Arkansas K-12 Standards in coursework as a foundation for teacher development

MEETS

Coursework clearly and intentionally familiarizes candidates with Arkansas K-12 State Standards throughout all grade bands within the licensure area. Evidence was seen in lesson planning activities within methods classes in the documentation submitted. Coursework integrates standards appropriate to the candidate's licensure area, and clinical courses require candidates to plan using relevant K-12 Arkansas standards. For example, in Collaborative Practice (MAT 5093), candidates unpack state standards to write outcome-focused SMART goals. Candidates in Teaching Literacy II (EED 4273) demonstrate strategies in literary and expository texts that promote oral language in grades K-3 and 4-6. Assessment Driven STEM Instruction (TEDU 4343) integrates Arkansas Science Standards K-6 and 5-8. One participant in the Coursework focus group said, "Everything is tied back to the standards. In Reading Strategies, we had to take standards and map them to the state standards. We have unpacked them, what the parts are, which ones are essential, and what's important, and prioritized them". Of the four courses observed, two of them referenced the State Standards. In one course, Assessment Driven Language Arts, the reviewers observed the K-12 Standards included on the PowerPoint. The text used in the class matched the standards, and the activity revolved around lesson planning and choosing the grade-appropriate standards to include in the lesson plan.

Coursework clearly and intentionally provides candidates with opportunities to vertically integrate standards throughout all grade bands within the licensure area. Reviewers saw evidence of this in the Assessment Driven Instruction course (MSED433), which included a protocol for reviewing instructional material in their PLC and activities such as unpacking K-12 Standards.

Criteria 2.1b: Candidates' coursework supports their development as a teacher

MEETS

Metric 1: Sequence and progression of courses

MEETS

Courses are clearly and intentionally sequenced across programs of study to build off previous coursework, providing candidates with an opportunity to show proficiency. SAU's courses include reinforcement opportunities for candidate growth areas and show a progressive increase in rigor. In the "Initial Programs Standards and Alignment Guide," matrices for TESS and the Arkansas Teaching Standards include all appropriate syllabi and are labeled with 'I,' 'R,' and 'P' to illustrate the progression of skills through coursework. Participants in the Course Instructor focus group gave examples of how coursework progresses from introductory classes to more advanced coursework, such as Literacy I, Literacy II, and then Assessment Driven ELA Instruction. Reviewers observed this progression in the Assessment Driven ELA course when the instructor made connections to previous learning in Literacy I and II.

Metric 2: Incorporation and utilization of Arkansas Educator Competencies and Arkansas Teaching Standards in coursework

MEETS

Coursework clearly and intentionally incorporates Arkansas Educator Competencies and Arkansas Teaching Standards to develop candidates to meet the knowledge and skills required for their licensure area. A chart is included in the submitted evidence to show when different elements of ATS and TESS are introduced, reinforced and when a candidate should be proficient. In all four course observations, reviewers noted that the syllabi were based on and aligned with the Educator Competencies and Arkansas Teaching Standards. For instance, in one course, examples of ATS alignment included working with the standards, planning for instruction, modeling, and discussing learner differences in the classroom.

Metric 3: Alignment of coursework to clinical experience

EXCEEDS

Coursework is clearly and intentionally aligned to clinical experience, and evidence shows that the Governance meetings evaluate and work towards continuous improvement for the Rider Residency model. In the documents provided, evidence shows specific references to clinical experiences throughout the syllabi. A few examples include TESOL Methods and Materials (ENGL4033), and TESOL Second Language Acquisition (ENGL4013). In both TESOL classes, candidates observe 10 hours in a classroom, work with an ELL student for the semester, and report on the experience in a culminating project. In Teaching Literacy I (EED 4173) and Teaching Literacy II (EED 4273), candidates have clinical experience requirements: 20 hours in kindergarten or first grade and 20 hours in the elementary grades. - Assessment Driven Language Arts Instruction (MSED4333) also includes field experiences. Some syllabi include descriptions of discussions and journal writing activities about their clinical experiences. In the Course Instructor focus group, participants spoke about increased clinical experience hours. SAU uses the POP Cycle, which includes the pre-observation, observation, and post-observation coaching sessions and guides how clinical supervisors coach their

teaching candidates. Part of the POP cycle collects data about the candidates' experiences in the field. The data is used to help connect and inform coursework and class discussions.

Candidates consistently have opportunities to reflect on and articulate the alignment with their clinical supervisor and course instructors. The "Traditional Clinical Sequences Chart" shows some connection between clinical experiences and coursework. In one course observation, the instructor started class with a round-robin discussion of clinical observations. She explained the reasons behind classroom management strategies that candidates were observing in the field. They discussed Advanced Placement (AP) preparation for writing and the importance of timed essay practice. The instructor asked one teaching candidate to follow up on an observation from their field experience and gather strategies on grading as well. They also discussed management and academic strategies for helping students with diverse needs called "read, write the room". Finally, they discussed Illustrative Math and how to analyze common formative assessments (CFAs) by sorting and color-coding the data, which would be used to plan follow-up lessons.

Criteria 2.1c: Candidates are provided with knowledgeable and effective course instructors

MEETS

Metric 1: Quality of course instructors

MEETS

Most course instructors show deep knowledge of Arkansas K-12 State Standards, content knowledge, and content pedagogy. In the "Milestone 3 Candidate Perception Survey 2022-2023", one question, "SAU prepared me for my content knowledge and pedagogical understanding," received an overall score of 3.72 out of 4 from traditional candidates across all pathways. The information in the Faculty Roster shows that most faculty are teaching courses that align with their experience. Many faculty are trained in relevant practices for their courses, such as Eureka Math training, RISE and LETRS, Math Quest, and CKLA. Fifteen of the eighteen faculty listed are TESS trained and normed. Most faculty members have experience teaching K-12 in the area they are instructing. Course Instructor focus group participants indicated continuing their education through professional memberships, conferences, research, and training.

Metric 2: Effectiveness of course instructors

MEETS

Most course instructors show evidence of strong facilitation of coursework and providing feedback and support. In the Coursework Participant focus group, one teaching candidate said, "They [course instructors] are quality PEOPLE, not just educators; they are very professional and go above and beyond, and how far they are willing to go for every person." Everyone in the focus group nodded in agreement. All participants indicated they receive high-quality feedback to help them improve their coursework and field experiences. In one observation, the instructor showed evidence of providing feedback and support by presenting the content, referencing and explaining primary sources, interacting with students during small group work, and encouraging a student to meet with her after class for help with a project.

INDICATOR 2.2: CLINICAL EXPERIENCES

Criteria 2.2a: Candidates are provided clinical experiences throughout their program that support their development as a teacher

EXCEEDS

Metric 1: The sequence of clinical experiences

EXCEEDS

The overall sequence of clinical experiences clearly and intentionally builds off previous experiences and includes opportunities for learning and development. For example, the "SAU Traditional Clinical Sequences Map" shows how candidates progress from Residency I to Residency II and from supervised field experiences to student teaching. A gradual release model has been implemented, as evidenced in the orientation and training materials for mentors and cooperating teachers. One Clinical Experience focus group participant corroborated this by saying they (teaching candidates) progressed from mini lessons to observations to their internship. The rest of the group nodded in agreement. Teaching candidates also shared how clinical experiences are embedded in their coursework before they start their internship or residency, and that clinical experiences increase in rigor. SAU has developed a system for evaluating and improving how candidates' clinical experiences are sequenced. Evidence was submitted of Governance Meeting agendas and minutes that include discussion and decisions around the candidates' clinical experiences

(co-teaching, POP cycle data, and mentor progress reports). One specific example documents discussion and decision-making in the 3-day versus 5-day structure of the residency. Also, in IEPC minutes on 9.14.23, the group discussed clinical curricular decisions regarding the Milestone Gateway Expectations. The decision was that the Gateway would be tied to POP cycles; if not met, the candidate would be placed on a development plan.

Metric 2: The variety of clinical experiences

EXCEEDS

Various clinical placements provide adequate opportunities for candidates to work with students with varied learning needs. SAU intentionally partners with multiple districts in Southern Arkansas and has selection criteria to determine district partnerships. The criteria include adequate numbers of qualified Mentor Teachers, district and campus leadership, low academic achievement, clustering, proximity, vacancies, and district initiatives. Evidence submitted includes the "Initial Demographic Map of Clinical Placements 2020-2024".

One Clinical Experience focus group participant said that they teach students with 504 plans and IEPs, and many of their students have diverse learning needs. Another participant said that when she is in clinical, she teaches all students and must differentiate learning for them. Everyone else in the group agreed. In the Clinical Supervisor focus group, they explained that SAU is intentional about partnerships to ensure candidates are immersed in diverse learning populations. The candidates' placements for course field experiences differ from their internship or residency.

Reviewers saw examples of this when they observed coaching from the clinical supervisor. One clinical coaching debrief discussed scaffolding strategies for two students with IEPs; in another debrief, they discussed a student with challenging behaviors. In each of the four coaching observations, they reviewed student achievement and referred to the TESS rubric in the POP cycle throughout the discussion.

As evidenced in the Governance meetings, SAU continually reflects on its partnerships, clinical experiences, and opportunities to develop teachers.

Criteria 2.2b: Candidates across the program are provided with an effective clinical internship

MEETS

Metric 1: The Effectiveness of Experienced Mentor Teachers

MEETS

Most experienced mentor teachers are equipped and demonstrate that they have the coaching skills to properly support and develop a candidate's pedagogical development. SAU has a specifically defined job description for the Rider Residency experienced mentor teacher role. They also have provided training in September, October, and February this year. Training includes orientation to roles and responsibilities, support structures, co-teaching, coaching, and POP cycles, and goals for the year. Subsequent training focuses on high-quality feedback, a common understanding of TESS, and aligning standards to the curriculum. There is also training for mentors working with the traditional track of interns.

In one of the coaching observations, reviewers heard evidence of mentors working with the candidate to support and coach the candidate in improving pedagogical development. The clinical supervisor and teaching candidate discussed how the mentor teacher coaches the candidate around pulling students during RTI time, the differentiated process, and the goals for each group of students. In the Clinical Experience focus group, all participants agreed that they worked with a mentor and that their mentor was effective. One participant said, "[My] mentor is amazing and has been welcoming since last summer. We met and shared expectations. She gives feedback to me all the time and allowed me to jump right into team teaching. She helps me work on the things I need to grow in. She's also learning from me."

Note: By 2026-2027, evidence that experienced mentor teachers working with year-long residents have received DESE-recognized coaching training must be shown to meet this metric.

Metric 2: Quality of selection process for experienced mentor teachers

EXCEEDS

A clear and intentional process is in place to select experienced mentor teachers. The "Mentor Teacher Roles and Responsibilities" document lists criteria that include years of classroom experience with exemplary evaluations, instructional leadership experience, and demonstrated instructional effectiveness.

SAU has a system for continuous improvement. Survey data from multiple stakeholders, including candidates and clinical supervisors, is collected and uploaded to a Mentor Teacher Tracker. At the end of the semester, the data is evaluated, and decisions are made about whether to continue working with individual mentors.

Note: By 2026–2027, evidence that experienced mentor teachers working with year-long residents have a minimum 3 years teaching experience, hold a standard Arkansas educators license with a Lead or Master Professional Educator designation, and have evidence of an annual rating of effective or higher in DESE’s Educator Effectiveness System must be shown to meet this metric.

Metric 3: Quality of clinical supervisors
EXCEEDS

Most program clinical supervisors show evidence of effective instructional practices and coaching with a positive impact. Clinical supervisors hold teaching licenses, have multiple years of K-12 teaching experience, and attend professional development and training.

After Residency II, all residents and mentor teachers complete an “Evaluation of Site Coordinator (Clinical Supervisor) survey” developed by SAU. The Quality Assurance Coordinator compiles the survey data and provides it to the Teacher Education Department Chair. The Department Chair meets individually with district administrators to discuss Site Coordinator fit or any concerns from either party.

In addition to the above measures, all faculty members are evaluated annually by their peers. This occurs during the annual peer review process and is completed by their department chair, the dean of the college, and by student evaluations administered by the university. Survey data submitted as evidence gave insight into the candidates’ perceptions of their university supervisors (clinical supervisors). The results indicate that candidates feel their supervisors support them and are strong instructors.

Metric 4: Quality of feedback to candidates
MEETS

In the Clinical Experience focus group, one participant shared that they get daily feedback from their mentor. The mentor asks the following questions: “Did the lesson work? What can we improve on? Did we modify this correctly? Let’s look at CFAs to see which students mastered the objective and who did not. We will use it to pull them into interventions”. All participants agreed that the feedback is helpful and built on previous feedback. One example given was about a time the mentor teacher suggested a resource to use in the next day’s lesson to improve the clarity of a math lesson. The teaching candidate said that is a common occurrence, and then they go back to the assessments and analyze the results. Her mentor is always suggesting ways to make a lesson even better.

Candidates consistently receive high-quality feedback from their clinical supervisor also. Reviewers found evidence of this in all four coaching sessions. The clinical supervisors gave feedback on effective instructional practices throughout the lesson and suggested ways to improve. They engaged the teaching candidates in sharing their thoughts and ideas. The feedback occurred weekly, and the “POP Cycle Packet” with TESS scores was emailed after their discussion. Feedback was linked to evidence of student learning and built on the previous feedback. The “POP Cycle Packet” includes all previous formal feedback and a section for the candidate to analyze student data from the observed lesson. Some discussion topics included maintaining a constant growth mindset, higher-level questions for understanding, student engagement, holding high expectations, and pacing.

Evidence submitted shows that SAU has a comprehensive evaluation system, including candidate perceptions, peer evaluations, and supervisor evaluations, to show the effectiveness of clinical supervisors. Their system measures and tracks supervisor quality and effectiveness, and they meet regularly to analyze results.

Note: By 2024–25, evidence that the Aspiring Teacher Rubric is in use by EPPs must be shown to meet this metric.

Criteria 2.2c: Strong partnerships exist between the EPP and K12 schools and districts that facilitate the development of strong candidates
MEETS

Metric 1: Quality of partnership with districts/schools
EXCEEDS

Collaborative processes are in place between SAU and most of their partner districts and schools to co-construct the clinical internship for candidates. SAU has a clear vision for its partnerships with schools. Through the “Recruitment Progression and Completion Plan,” SAU has outlined priorities for building partnerships in high-need areas that support students of all populations. Through quarterly Governance meetings, SAU and their school partners openly communicate about progress towards their shared goals, how to strengthen their partnership and the quality of support for their residents. One School and District Partnership focus group participant said, “We respond to their [SAU’s] needs, and they respond to us.” SAU has taken feedback from districts and customized its program for its partners. For example, one participant mentioned that the district brought concerns about teaching candidates struggling with TESS domain 3b, around questioning. SAU focused on supporting candidates in that domain and embedded practice in seminars. The participant shared that the data shows that SAU’s teaching candidates’ ability to use questioning and discussion techniques is improving.

Evidence shows that in the Rider Residency model, there is strong collaboration between mentor teachers and clinical supervisors. Clinical supervisors attend monthly training and summer conferences to continually develop and calibrate their support of residents. They also develop coaching skills through training and conversations with each other.

Metric 2: Support and development for clinical supervisors

MEETS

Collaborative processes are in place that support and develop effective clinical supervisors. One example of collaborative support is having clinical supervisors attend district-led PLC team meetings with their residents. Clinical supervisors also lead mentor teacher trainings that are focused on predetermined development topics and responsive support to current candidate needs. All faculty and instructors must be HQ-approved and APP QMR certified for online instruction.

INDICATOR 2.3: DEVELOPMENT

Criteria 2.3a: Candidates are successful with their program coursework

MEETS

Metric 1: Candidate proficiency in coursework

MEETS

Most candidates show proficiency in coursework requirements. Evidence submitted included the “Milestone 1 Admission GPA Chart”, which showed the GPA admission data for the last three years. For unconditional admission, students must have a 3.0 GPA and meet minimum basic reading, writing, and math skills requirements. The average GPA at enrollment was 3.41. Milestone 3 Exit GPA for traditional candidates upon graduation was 3.51, indicating that teacher candidates successfully complete their coursework throughout the program.

Metric 2: Quality of candidate support across coursework

EXCEEDS

SAU teaching candidates are consistently provided with an individualized support plan if their coursework requirements are not on track, and they take an active role in creating the plan and monitoring progress. They meet this metric and utilize a system for continuous improvement to track and evaluate support plan effectiveness. Evidence submitted shows an alert system in place to monitor professional expectations, including coursework. A 4-step process is in place to set goals and track progress with timelines to help the student get back on track. The plan calls for faculty members to meet with the candidate and develop suggestions for improvement together. During steps 2-4, the candidate is present, acknowledges the plan, and meets with the educator to provide evidence or documentation of the stated remediation. The tracker shows real-time progress, next steps, and resolution.

Criteria 2.3b: Candidates are successful in their clinical internship

MEETS

Metric 1: Candidate attainment of clinical internship goals and milestones

MEETS

SAU has a set of clear and appropriate goals and milestones for their candidates’ clinical internships. There are four milestones mapped out in the “Expectations Guide.” It lists the timeline, assessor, and minimum criteria for success. Most candidates meet clinical experience goals and milestones. The “Milestone 2” evidence submitted showed a

three-year trend of more than 85% of traditional candidates scoring “Effective” on all 4 TESS domains. In the “Milestone 3” data, more than 90% of all traditional candidates scored “Effective” on all 4 TESS domains.

In the Clinical Experience focus group, candidates clearly articulated what they needed to do to meet milestones and graduate.

Metric 2: Candidate impact on student growth

MEETS

There is adequate evidence that candidates can impact student growth. In the evidence submitted, most candidates are rated “effective” on TESS, which requires them to positively impact student learning. There is also evidence of POP cycle growth. Each cycle contains a student achievement chart that candidates must complete showing assessment scores from their students.

In the Clinical Experience focus group, one participant confirmed that Residents work with student data. They complete pre-assessments, plan lessons, and use data to guide them. In the Clinical Experiences focus group, one candidate said, “I do a pre-and post-assessment for every lesson I teach so I can see exactly what my students need. After the lesson, I compiled the data to see who did not meet the standard. I can pull them into a small group to help them.” Another participant said they have time set aside during the day for intervention, during which students who have not mastered a skill on a CFA can be retaught.

Metric 3: Candidate proficiency in effective teaching skills

EXCEEDS

Most candidates receive a score of “Effective” on the TESS rubric. Evidence shows that in the “Milestone 3” data, more than 90% of all traditional candidates scored “Effective” on all 4 TESS domains. Data is reviewed in Governance meetings and by the IEPC. Both groups look at data that tracks trends in TESS domains to inform changes and continuously improve.

Note: By 2024–25, evidence that the Aspiring Teacher Rubric is in use by EPPs must be shown to meet this metric.

Metric 4: Quality of candidate support across clinical internship

EXCEEDS

All candidates are provided with the support they need to be effective. Struggling candidates are provided an individualized support plan if their development in the clinical internship is not on track. SAU utilizes a system to track and evaluate support plan effectiveness. The system is the “Tracker of Alerts and Milestone Expectations 2023–2024,” and the individual support plans are linked in the tracker. There is a three-step plan for monitoring and providing support to individuals. In the Clinical Experiences focus group, participants corroborated this support. All candidates raised their hands in agreement that they receive what they need to be successful in their internship. One participant said, “I know if I give feedback and say I’m struggling in an area, my supervisor will respond to that and help me. The feedback has given me the confidence to know I can do this.”

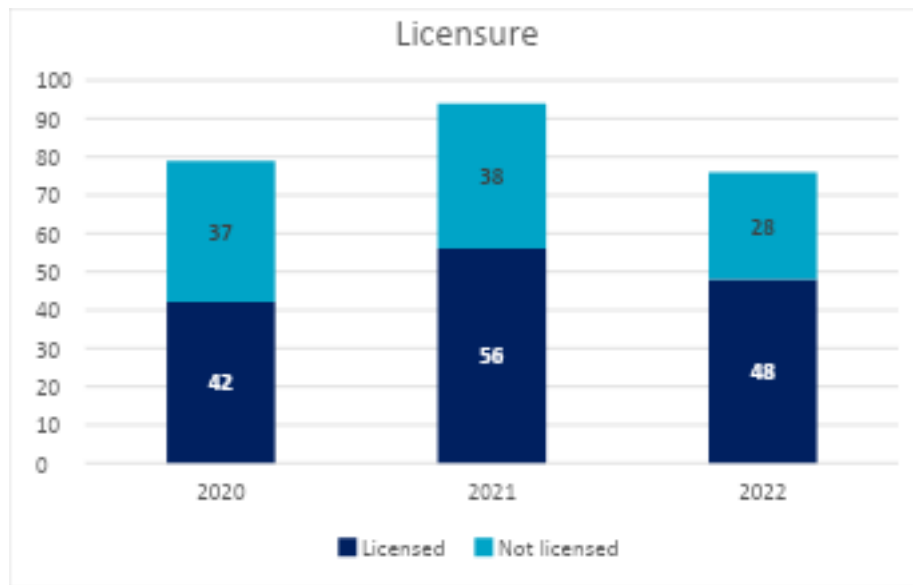
The “Recruitment, Progression and Completion Plan” evidence on page 11 describes strategies for retaining high-performing candidates. In the Mentor Teacher focus group, mentor teachers agreed that high-performing candidates receive opportunities and feedback that encourage their retention including recruitment and job offers. One mentor summed it up: “Everybody wants to hire them.”

STANDARD 3: SUPPORTING WORKFORCE NEEDS

Standard 3 Performance Level		
MEETS		
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 3.1 Licensure	Indicator 3.2 Employment	Indicator 3.3 Effectiveness
BELOW	MEETS	EXCEEDS
Recommendations		
SAU's traditional program meets or exceeds nearly all of the State's targets for EPPs to support Arkansas's workforce needs, including completers who become licensed, work in Arkansas public schools and districts (including priority districts and subjects), and stay in the classroom for multiple years. EPP Supervisors and Completers feel that SAU prepares candidates well to be teachers. Recommendations include: Establish programmatic support to ensure that traditional program completers are prepared to obtain standard licensure. <i>(Focus Area: Criteria 3.1a)</i>		

INDICATOR 3.1: LICENSURE

Criteria 3.1a: A high proportion of program candidates obtain a standard license			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Licensed	Performance Level
Percentage of completers who have earned a standard license within one year of completion	76%	59%	BELOW

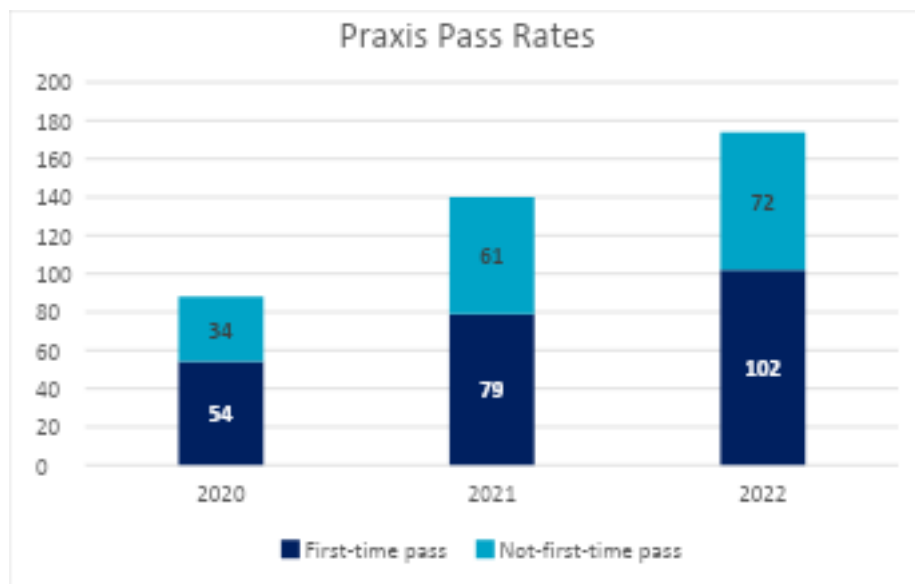


Criteria 3.1b: A high proportion of alternative route enrollees are provisionally licensed

Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Licensed	Performance Level
Percentage of employed alternative route enrollees who are provisionally licensed	n/a	n/a	n/a

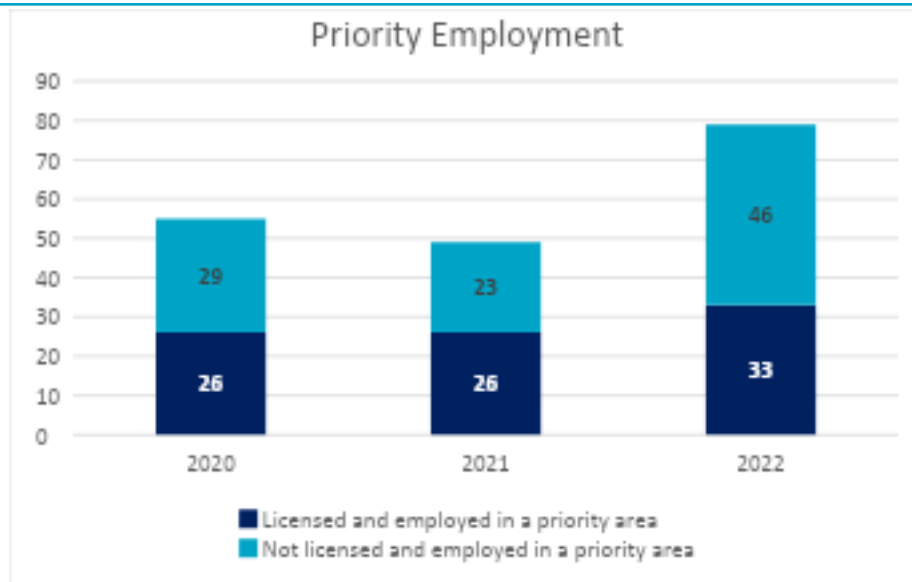
Criteria 3.1c: A high proportion of traditional program candidates pass the content exam in their area on the first try

Metric	Target	EPP's First-Time Pass Percentage	Performance Level
Percentage of first-time licensure exam test takers that pass on their first try	65%	58.5%	APPROACHING



INDICATOR 3.2: EMPLOYMENT

Criteria 3.2a: A high proportion of completers are employed in Arkansas's public schools															
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Employed	Performance Level												
Percentage of completers who are licensed and gain employment in Arkansas public schools in their first three years after completion	64%	57.4%	APPROACHING												
Employment <table><thead><tr><th>Year</th><th>Licensed and employed</th><th>Not licensed and employed</th></tr></thead><tbody><tr><td>2020</td><td>29</td><td>26</td></tr><tr><td>2021</td><td>32</td><td>17</td></tr><tr><td>2022</td><td>44</td><td>35</td></tr></tbody></table>				Year	Licensed and employed	Not licensed and employed	2020	29	26	2021	32	17	2022	44	35
Year	Licensed and employed	Not licensed and employed													
2020	29	26													
2021	32	17													
2022	44	35													
Criteria 3.2b: A high proportion of completers work in high-priority Arkansas public school districts and subjects															
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Employed Priority	Performance Level												
Percentage of completers who are licensed and gain employment in high-priority Arkansas public school districts and subjects in their first three years after completion	40%	46.4%	EXCEEDS												



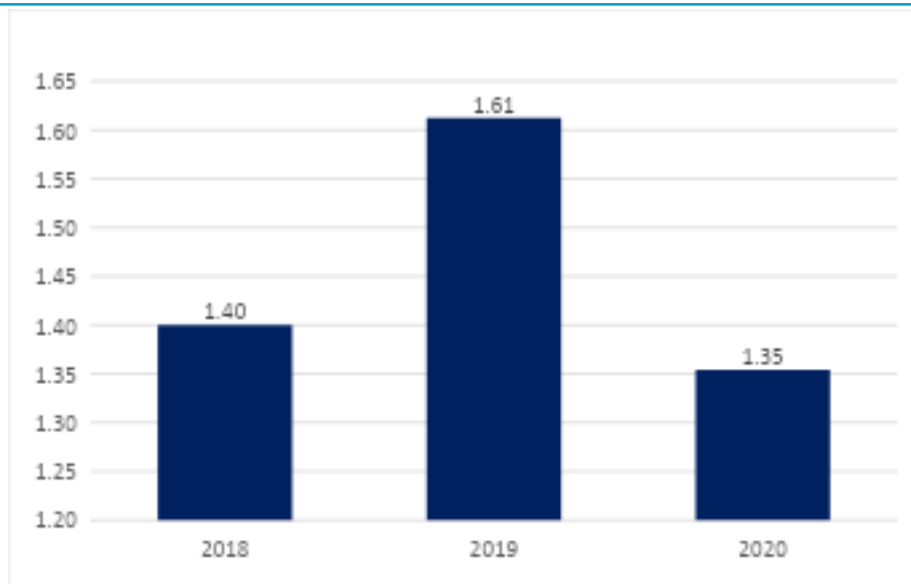
*Priority Employment is employment in a high-need subject area and/or geographical shortage area. Shortage Areas are based on an analysis of 3yrs of data related to teacher supply (EPP pipeline), demand (unlicensed teachers, attrition, deceased), and state focus areas.

Current subject shortage areas for employment: Computer Science, Secondary Science, Foreign Language, Secondary Math, Middle School Math, Middle School Science, and Special Education.

Current geographical shortage areas are school districts located in the following co-op regions: Arkansas River ESC, Great Rivers ESC, Pulaski Co Schools, Southeast AR ESC.

Criteria 3.2c: Program completers remain in the classroom for multiple years

Metric	Target	EPP's Average Years of Experience, 3 Years After Completion	Performance Level
Program completers' average licensed teaching experience in Arkansas's public schools 3 years after completion	1.7	1.44	MEETS



INDICATOR 3.3: EFFECTIVENESS

Criteria 3.3a: School leaders rate program completers that they hire as effective classroom teachers			
Metric	Target	EPP's Average Percentage of Agree+ on all Survey Items	Performance Level
School leaders' perception of program completer effectiveness based on responses to the EPP Completer Supervisor Survey conducted annually by DESE	81%	83.3%	EXCEEDS
Criteria 3.3b: Completers feel that their program prepared them well to be a teacher			
Metric	Target	EPP's Average Percentage of Agree+ on all Survey Items	Performance Level
Program completers' perception of how well their program prepared them to be a teacher based on responses to the EPP Completer Survey conducted annually by DESE	75%	81.3%	EXCEEDS
Criteria 3.3c: A high proportion of program completers have above-average value-added scores			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage with Average Value-Added of 80+	Performance Level
Percentage of program completers who have above-average value-added scores in their first three years after completion	43%	39%	MEETS

